

There is no question that the poor are poorer, but the rich certainly are not richer. The man who had nothing has doubled one of his zeros, but the average millionaire has lost three of them. One of the richest men in the world, according to an intimate friend, dropped eight zeros—preceded by a seven or eight. The rich somehow always manage to beat the poor at everything, even in money losses.

An old-fashioned banker who philosophizes on the slightest provocation said to me the other day: "Humanity progresses through the recognition of its mistakes. It is reasonable to assume that this lesson will prove to be less expensive than we now think it."

"Why must we assume that we are learning it?" I asked.